

Ecology revision — Q and A

Q: What is a habitat?

A: The place where an organism lives

Q: What is a population?

A: All the organisms of one species living in a habitat

Q: What is a community?

A: All the populations of different species living in a habitat

Q: What is an ecosystem?

A: The interaction of a community of living organisms with the non-living parts of their environment

Q: What is a producer?

A: An organism that makes its own food, usually by photosynthesis

Q: What is a biotic factor?

A: A living factor that affects a community

Q: Give an example of an abiotic factor.

A: Light intensity, temperature, moisture, soil pH or wind

Q: What does a quadrat measure?

A: The number of organisms in a small sample area

Q: What is interdependence?

A: When species in a community depend on each other for food, shelter, pollination or seed dispersal

Q: What do decomposers do?

A: They break down dead organisms and return nutrients to the soil